



The Lake Forest Park Road Association Newsletter
Town of Sturgeon Bay, WI

*Published twice yearly
Spring 2026*

President's Post

by David Wood (2810 LFPR)
president@lakeforestparkrd.org

With the vestiges of Blizzard Elsa's historic snowfall still lying on the ground on this last day of March, it can take real Wisconsin fortitude to believe that winter will ever end. But when you look a little closer, you can see the signs that we will soon be enjoying another beautiful Door County spring!

Another sign of spring is that it is time for the UW-Oshkosh Spring Private Well Monitoring program, with an imminent signup deadline of April 3: <http://uwo.sh/doorco-wells-spring26>. This program is incredibly important to understanding the impact of agricultural runoff on water quality. If you miss this program, the UW-Oshkosh will run a water lab at the Crossroads at Big Creek from May 26 to September 2; you can pick up empty and drop off full sample kits Monday-Thursday 12PM-3PM. And their lab in Oshkosh is open year round, with pickups Monday-Friday 8am-4pm and drop-offs Monday-Thursday 8am-3pm. The lab is located at 783 Pearl Ave, Oshkosh WI 54901.

Once spring has fully arrived, and the ground dries out a little, AT&T and their contractors will finish installing the fiber optic links they need to begin offering high speed broadband internet service. They have also promised to clean up any damage done during installation to private property and in the right-of-way. Stay tuned for more information!

The spring Annual Meeting will be held on **Saturday, June 6 at the Crossroads**. Social hour begins at 9 am, guest speaker at 10am, with the membership meeting to follow at 10:45-ish. With no new volunteer to host the meeting, the social hour will be BYOB (Bring Your Own Beverage) and optional BSTS (Bring Snacks To Share), just as we do for Picnics In Portage Park.

President's Post

This issue of *Between Lake and Forest* features a brief “preview” article about the Door County Land Trust’s recent acquisition of *The Dennis and Susan Garrity Family Tract at Kellner Fen Natural Area*. This tract encompasses 149 acres fronting Lake Forest Park Road from approximately 2796 LFPR to approximately 2912 LFPR. This acquisition, which will be officially announced closer to Earth Day, was made possible through the generosity of our neighbors Dennis and Sue Garrity (2668 LFPR). Please join me in saying “Thank You” to Dennis and Sue!

The Picnics in Portage Park (PIPPs) will continue again on the 12th day of June, July, August, and September, from 5-7 pm. As in the past, I intend to bring a keg of homebrewed beer on the days I can attend to facilitate the conversation. We have reserved The Sawyer Park Pavilion for Oktoberfest on Saturday October 10, 2026. We are looking for **new volunteers** to coordinate this event, but if no one steps up we will revert to BYOB/BSTS like the PIPPs.



I look forward to seeing you at one of our upcoming events, or just along the road!

Changes

Moving

Ruth Sandor (2980 LFPR) will be moving to an assisted living home in Madison. You may write to her at the Madison address in the Road Directory and **Bela** will pass it on. Please reach out and say hello.

Passings

Neil Patrick Fullan, M.D., (3130 LFPR) passed away peacefully on Feb. 1, 2026. Neil is survived by his wife, Dr. Sally Schlise, and other family members. Neil was a graduate of the University of Notre Dame and Rush University Medical School, and was honorably discharged from the U.S. Navy after serving as a pilot. Neil was known for his generosity, love of learning, and sense of humor. He loved a good joke and could be silly, especially with children. He also was notorious for deadpan teasing where you weren’t always sure if he was kidding or not. Neil’s legacy will live on through the many people who bloomed under his attention and care. (Adapted from *The Door County Pulse*.)

LFPRA Events - Print Out & Save!

Road Business Events

- **Sunday, May 10:**
Membership forms are DUE
to Jon Krainak
- **Saturday, June 6, 9 am:**
Annual Meeting at Crossroads
- **Thursday, October 1:**
Fall Newsletter submission deadline

Picnics in Portage Park!

All events take place from 5-7 pm

- **Friday, June 12**
- **Sunday, July 12**
- **Wednesday, August 12**
- **Saturday, September 12**

Dog Days at Shiloh Road Bark Park

All events take place at 10 am

- **Thursday, June 11**
- **Thursday, July 9**
- **Thursday, August 13**
- **Thursday, September 10**

****Rain dates the following Fridays**

Women's Book Group at 5th & Jefferson Coffee House

All events take place at 10 am

- **Thursday, June 18**
- **Thursday, July 16**
- **Thursday, August 20**
- **Thursday, September 17**

Reflection: Living Between Lake and Forest

by Hanna Ziolkowski (2753 LFPR)



We live between Lake and Forest
We are lucky here
We don't have to choose
We have it all.

We can cross either path as we feel
We can meet deer on the walk in the forest.

We can meet fox on walk on the beach.

There are no boundaries.
We are free here,
Like an eagle to cross each path.

The Lake in winter is majestic,
Each day is different, never the same.

Winter in the Forest is like open book,
You can tell who lives there and what is their
schedule.

Soon we will be able to spot another wonder of
nature,
Plants, Birds, Trees all will wake up,
And we will be in the middle of a wonderland
once again.

Picnics in Portage Park



Summer brings warmth, tourists, houseguests, and the Road Association's venerable institution: the PiPP!

On the **12th of each summer month** (June, July, August, and September), we meet up at Portage Park from **5 to 7 pm** for some fun and socializing.

Bring a chair, your beverage of choice and, if you like, a snack to share with everyone. You can even bring your houseguests!

Come meet your neighbors and enjoy the beautiful view. (If we're lucky, President David Wood will treat us to his home-brewed beer.)

Friendly reminder signs will be posted on the Road on PiPP days, but mark your calendar *now* so you don't miss out.

Cheers, and PiPP, PiPP, hooray!

The Return of Dog Day!

Last summer's inaugural session of Dog Day was so popular that we continued meeting into the Autumn. If you missed it, now's your chance.

All sociable Lake Forest Park Road dogs are invited to bring their two-legged friends and hang out with their neighbors at the **Shiloh Road Bark Park, 1660 Shiloh Road, Sturgeon Bay.**

Dog Day happens on the **SECOND Thursday of the month at 10 a.m.**

The rain date is the following Friday.

Come get your bark on!



Road Directories



You know it; you love it; you can't live without it - it's the LFPRA printed Road Directory!

The Road Directory is a benefit of your membership dues; extra copies are available for \$5 each.

Directory/Database Manager Jon Krainak works diligently to gather information and shepherd the Directory through the publication process.

YOU can help by submitting your information accurately, either electronically or via the printed form in this newsletter.

See pages 7 and 8 of this newsletter for details.

Lake Forest Park Road Association Officers		
President	David Wood	president@lakeforestparkrd.org
Vice-President	Tom Bennett	vicepresident@lakeforestparkrd.org
Treasurer	Annette Vincent	treasurer@lakeforestparkrd.org
Board Member	Bob Brown	skybob70@yahoo.com
Board Member	Eileen Brown	ebrown3@aol.com
Board Member	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
Board Member	Pat Nell	patnell1914@gmail.com
Committees and Volunteers		
Adopt-a-Road	Hans and Carol Borcharding	hansborcharding@yanoo.com
	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
	Gina Morgan	gina3@charter.net
Broadband	Jeff Feuerstein	jefffeuerstein@hotmail.com
	David Wood	president@lakeforestparkrd.org
Directory/Database Manager	Jon Krainak	jonathan.krainak@gmail.com
Facebook Page	Kim Krueger	805shiva@gmail.com
Moderators	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
Historian	John Vincent	jsvco@sbcglobal.net
Newsletter Editor	Kim Krueger	805shiva@gmail.com
Octoberfest	POSITION OPEN	
	POSITION OPEN	
PiPP Signs	Jeff Feuerstein	jefffeuerstein@hotmail.com
	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
	Annette and John Vincent	jsvco@sbcglobal.net
	David Wood	president@lakeforestparkrd.org
Propane Representatives	Mike Johnston	mlj.mike.johnston@gmail.com
	Rod Miller	roderickemiller@aol.com
Welcome Committee	Bonnie and Dennis Connolly	dconnoll@charter.net
	Jean Laundrie	dlaundrie@charter.net
Winter Dinner	Doug McGee	dpmcgee1925@charter.net

Spring into Membership!

by Jon Krainak, Directory/Database Manager

It's time to rejoin the road association for 2026. We will be publishing a NEW printed Road Directory this year, so please double- and triple-check the information you submit to ensure that it is correct for the printed document.

PLEASE SUBMIT A NEW MEMBERSHIP FORM BY SUNDAY MAY 10, 2026 -- even if your information has not changed since the last Directory was published in 2024.

There are TWO ways to submit your information. You only need to do ONE of these.

DIGITAL: Google Form

You will get an email message from Jon Krainak, jonathan.krainak@gmail.com with the link to the Google Form. If you don't see the message, please check your spam folder.

The link follows and is also on the LFPRA Facebook page. <https://forms.gle/v4sqxKX6pyDk4f328>

DUES of \$15 must be mailed in or paid at the June Annual Meeting.

OR

TRADITIONAL: Paper Form

Print out the membership form on the next page of this newsletter and mail it to the Treasurer along with your dues.

PLEASE do not leave un-postmarked items, cash, or checks in Annette's mailbox.

DUES of \$15 must be mailed in or paid at the June Annual Meeting.

NEXT: PAY YOUR ANNUAL MEMBERSHIP DUES

Pay your \$15 annual dues via check made payable to the Lake Forest Park Road Association (LFPRA). **DO NOT SEND CASH, PLEASE.**

You may mail your printed membership forms with your dues and Annette will forward the forms to me.

Annette Vincent, LFPRA Treasurer
2794 Lake Forest Park Road
Sturgeon Bay, WI 54235
(708) 917-1274

After May 10, Annette will also have a drop box on her porch for dues. Please do not put un-postmarked items in her mailbox.

You may also pay your dues at the June Annual Meeting

If you have questions about the electronic or printable membership form, or the directory, please email Jonathan Krainak, LFPRA Directory/Database Manager at jonathan.krainak@gmail.com.

Thank you for participating in our Road Association.

*please
join us*

Lake Forest Park Road Association Membership Form

****PLEASE RETURN BY MAY 10, 2026****

If you are **NOT** using the electronic membership form, please print out and complete this form and return it with your membership dues of \$15, check payable to the Lake Forest Park Road Association (LFPRA). **PLEASE DO NOT SEND CASH.**

If you are using the electronic membership form, you will still need to submit your dues separately, which you can do by mail or at the June Membership Meeting.

Please mail checks and printed forms to:

Annette Vincent, LFPRA Treasurer
2794 Lake Forest Park Road
Sturgeon Bay, WI 54235
(708) 917-1274

Your email address (preferred contact) _____

Last name(s)_____ First name(s)_____

Co-owners' names & email (if any)_____

Sturgeon Bay fire road/house number and street_____

House Name, if any_____

Alternate (Legal, winter, permanent address): Post office box# OR House#/Street

Alternate (Legal, winter, permanent address): City/State/Zip

Which address is preferred for postal mailings? (Please choose one)

_____ Sturgeon Bay address _____ Alternate address (provide above)

Sturgeon Bay phone # (if any)_____

Phone # 2 / Owner's name (###-###-#### / Name)_____

Phone # 3 / Owner's name_____

Phone # 4 / Owner's name_____

If there is any other information you wish to share, please add it below:

Prost! Scenes from Oktoberfest

Bob and Eileen Brown (3110-3122 LFPR) and **Paul Lutzke (3301 LFPR)** put on another fabulous Oktoberfest in Fall 2025. A tasty spread from Sonny's and plenty of good cheer and good neighbors made for a lovely evening.

If the party is to continue, we will need **NEW organizers for 2026**. Bob, Eileen and Paul have "done their bit" for a few years now. So c'mon party people -- is it **your** turn to pick up the ceremonial beer stein? Please contact President David Wood to volunteer.



Photo credit: Eileen Brown

Forty Year Anniversary of the Winter Dinner

by Doug McGee (3268 LFPR)

The first Winter Dinner was organized by Rudy and Betty Nimphius in 1986 and held at The Nightingale Supper Club. They lived just south where Brad Nelson lives now. I don't know if they're still living, but they did move to a condo at Cherry Hills years ago. Their idea was to be able to bring folks together at the coldest and darkest time of the Winter to socialize and have a good meal. When we moved here, they were still in charge of planning the Winter Dinner. They were delightful people!



Photo credit: Kim Krueger

UW-Oshkosh Presentation on Door County Well Monitoring Program

by Annette Vincent (2794 LFPR)

On December 9, 2025, Dr. Greg Kleinheinz presented the results of the Fall Door County Well Monitoring Program via Zoom. The program can be viewed from the County website either on video (<https://youtu.be/kXVki7DNhDc>) or in pdf format (<https://www.co.door.wi.gov/DocumentCenter/View/9330/FINAL-Fall-2025-DC-Final-Presentation-128?bidId=>

This year, UWO received 112 additional samples covering 29 new map sections of Door County with at least one sample taken. They would really like to continue to expand coverage to monitor well water quality throughout the county. Dr. Kleinheinz also noted that the aquifer in Door County was not being replenished in the fall, probably because we were experiencing an extended dry period. This means contaminants were not being significantly transported into the aquifer, certainly not in comparison to wetter periods.

A mapped comparison of the Fall 2024 and 2025 data is shown in **Figure 1** on the following page. *Please note I have added the location of Gilbert farm on the map; this was not in the presentation.*

Figure 2 is a zoomed-in representation of a subset of the data.

With the additional samples, one can see that near Gilbert Farm, multiple wells have elevated nitrate levels. The manure spreading fields for Gilbert Farm extend for several miles from the actual location of the farm, potentially impacting wells in a wide area. Please also note that several of the higher nitrate samples are not visible on the map because the samples are close together and the dots overlap (compare the legend totals with what can be seen). Homes near the farm may need RO filters in order to have safe drinking water no matter the weather. This is also a further indication of the importance of monitoring wells being in place before the farm is allowed to expand.

I encourage everyone, but particularly those near the farm, to take part in the UW-Oshkosh Spring Well Monitoring Program to provide further data to the County that farm expansions in a karst environment are a problem for drinking water. County officials are unable to see private well testing results if they are not part of this study. Precise addresses are not disclosed.

The flyer for the UW-Oshkosh Spring Well testing program, which occurs on April 17 and 18, is on [page 13](#) of this newsletter.

Registration is accepted through April 3 and is only \$30 for the first 300 registrants.

You **must** sample on either April 17 or 18 **and** be able to drop samples at numerous collection sites on the peninsula.

Door County Well Monitoring Program (continued)

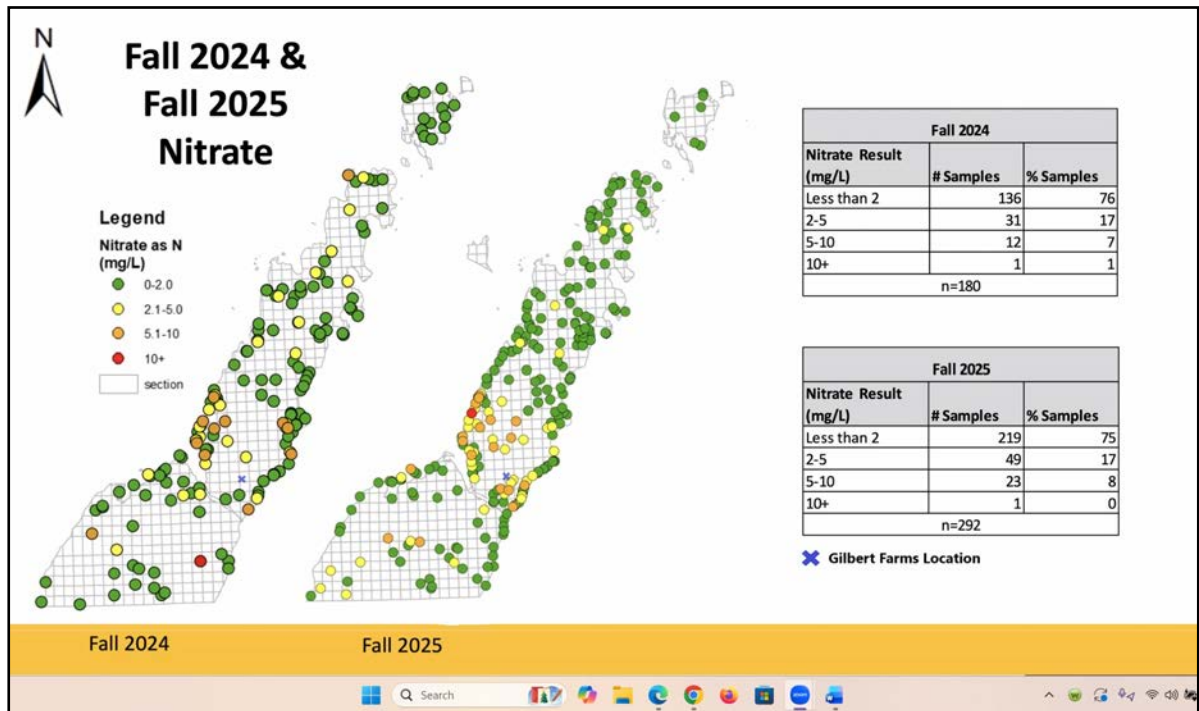


Figure 1

Door County Well Program Fall 2025 Nitrate (mg/L)

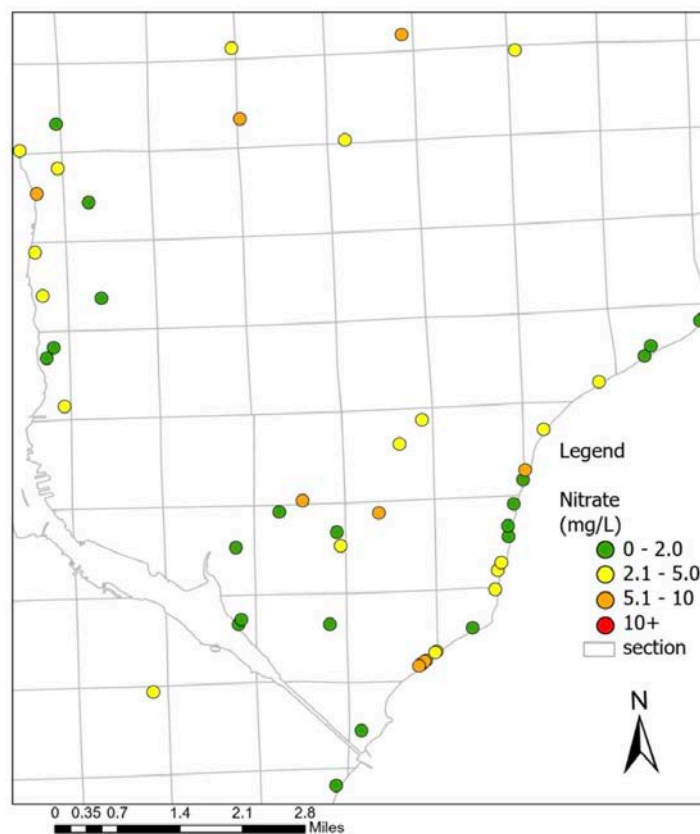


Figure 2

Door County Well Monitoring Program (continued)



UW UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN
OSHKOSH

Spring 2026 DOOR COUNTY PRIVATE WELL MONITORING PROGRAM

TESTING PARAMETERS

- 💧 Total coliforms/*E. coli* (quantification)
- 💧 Nitrate (Nitrate + nitrite as N)

Cost is only \$30*

**Discounted rate for the first 300 registrants; \$45 for those registering after the first 300 registrants.*

Optional arsenic, pH, alkalinity, hardness and iron tests available at an additional cost of \$25

ABOUT THE PROGRAM

The University of WI Oshkosh has been offering discounted well water quality testing through this program since 2019. The goal of this program is to provide education about the importance of testing your well water as well as build a database of groundwater quality data in Door County.

HOW IT WORKS

- RSVP using the link or QR code below by April 3rd
- Receive sampling kit in mail
- Attend a virtual forum to learn how to sample
- Return your kit April 17th and 18th at designated drop-off locations
- Receive your results & countywide summary of study



Registration accepted through April 3rd

RSVP online at uwo.sh/doorco-wells-spring26 or using the QR code

**Prepayment using a credit card is accepted when you RSVP online, otherwise mailed checks are accepted made out to UW Oshkosh. Note that sampling kits will not be mailed out until payment is received.*

Sample drop-off is April 17th & 18th – mark your calendars!

For more information, contact Jackie Behrens at eric@uwosh.edu or (920) 424-3148

DNR Hearing on Gilbert Farms CAFO

Adapted from *The Door County Pulse*, with additions by Kim Krueger (3364 LFPR)

On November 5, 2025, the Wisconsin DNR held a public hearing concerning the Gilbert Farms (5186 County Road T) permit application to expand their dairy farm into a CAFO (Concentrated Animal Feeding Operation).

Prior to the hearing, over 250 individuals had submitted written statements to the DNR, with 2/3 of those requesting a public hearing.

According to the *Door County Pulse*, 440 people attended the hearing, both in person and online via Zoom.

LFPR members were well represented, with several individuals speaking during the public comment portion of the hearing. Annette and John Vincent, Rod Miller, Mike Nelson, Tom Bennett and others made statements during the meeting.

Of the 62 public comments (in person and virtual), only 9 were in favor of the CAFO expansion. The hearing lasted for over 3 hours. The DNR also accepted further comments from the public up to November 12.

Joe Baeten, DNR Natural Resources Basin Supervisor, stated at the time that it will likely take the DNR several months to review all of the public comments and statements before the next steps in the process.

We will share any updates on this issue via email and the LFPR Facebook page.

Read the full text of the November 2025 article written by Eleanor Corbin here <https://doorcountypulse.com/over-400-attend-gilbert-farms-cafo-permit-public-hearing/>



Photo credit: Kim Krueger



Gilbert Farms CAFO Permit Update

by Rod Miller (5087 CTH TT)

As of March 27, 2026, the Wisconsin Department of Natural Resources (WDNR) has not yet issued a final ruling on the permit request to expand the facility at County T and Mathey Road into a Concentrated Animal Feeding Operation (CAFO).

The WDNR Notice of Final Determination is under internal review and will include responses to all letters opposing this expansion to over 2,400 animal units. There were over 200 letters of opposition submitted to the WDNR so the process has taken much longer than normal. A special thank you to all who have voiced opposition to the expansion of a factory farm in our neighborhood. We anxiously await the outcome of the WDNR's decision.

Our working group is moving forward with passion and commitment to advocate for clean water and controlling environmental pollution. Below is a brief introduction to the various activities we are undertaking.

Water Rangers Testing

The purpose is to test and monitor water quality in creeks and surface water that could be impaired by manure from the farm's production area or spreading fields. Three creeks have been identified so far: Lilly Bay Creek, Big Creek, and an unnamed creek emptying into Lake Michigan. Surface water of the Kellner Fen could also be affected.

Water testing will initially be conducted by a certified testing laboratory to establish a water quality baseline. Subsequent water testing, at two to four week intervals, will be conducted by a small team of recurring volunteers. Test results will be tracked and logged to enable monitoring and establish a historical database. Water sampling will take place as close to the contamination source as possible utilizing the nearest public access point.

Manure Spreading Monitoring

The purpose is to monitor the spreading of liquid manure on the spreading fields. The focus is to ensure that the spreading is done in compliance with the Nutrient Management Plan (NMP) and that the spreading is compliant with the restriction map for any given parcel.

Common restrictions include:

- 1) No spreading on parcels where the soil depth is less than 24 inches
- 2) No spreading on parcels with a high water table
- 3) No spreading on parcels within 100 feet of a private well
- 4) If the spreading is surface applied, it must be incorporated (disked or tilled in the soil) within 24 hours.

Gilbert Farms CAFO Permit Update (continued)

The monitoring is accomplished with volunteers who will document and take pictures of any suspected irregularities and report results to the WDNR.

By the way, if anyone is interested in participating, **we could use some more volunteers.** Please contact me at roderickemiller@aol.com or (972) 679-6332 if you are interested.

Operations Ordinance

We are having to accommodate larger and larger factory farms without clear answers about how the operations will affect property values, air quality, roads, emergency services, or long-term cleanup costs.

If a factory farm wants to operate in our community, it *must* show its homework. That means written plans, independent review, and financial responsibility—so neighbors and taxpayers aren't left paying the bill if something goes wrong.

WDNR does not regulate many of the impacts communities actually live with every day, like air emissions and odor, truck traffic, and road damage, fire and emergency response needs, disease prevention, carcass disposal, or what happens if a CAFO closes or fails.

Without local operating standards, towns and counties are asked to absorb new risks without clear plans, enforceable conditions, or financial protection.

An operations ordinance empowers local towns or county boards to decide what plans are needed, such as professional plans to address property value impacts, air and odor control, disease prevention, and fire and EMS readiness. An operations ordinance can also assign financial responsibility to the factory farm (not the taxpayer) to pay for review, monitoring, and enforcement

Door County's economy and identity are deeply tied to clean water, healthy land, tourism and quality of life. Most residents rely on private wells.

Once groundwater is contaminated, there is no easy fix. Prevention matters.



Photo credit: Destination Door County

LFPR Third Thursday Women's Book Group

by Kim Krueger (3364 LFPR), with contributions from Book Group members

The women's book group meets on the **third Thursday** of the month at **5th and Jefferson Coffeehouse** at **10:00 a.m.** If you are a female resident of the road and would like to join us, please email **Donna Janning** at dwjanning@gmail.com. Here's our latest book report.



Illustration credit: Clare Schneider, NPR

October 2025: North Woods by Daniel Mason (Fiction)

This was a polarizing title! Many disliked the book, and most had a hard time getting into it despite multiple attempts. Then again, a couple of us loved it, finding it unique and poetic. The author drew some interesting parallels between the extinction of trees and the decline of humanity, but the jumping timeline could be hard to follow. We had questions about whether the ghosts in the tale were "real", and if we too could haunt the land we occupied in life. Sometimes the best discussions are about controversial titles.

November 2025: A Lost Lady by Willa Cather (Fiction)

A worthwhile read. The protagonist adapted to her diminished circumstances given her limited options. Whatever her flaws may have been, she was a survivor. Women's choices being limited by outside forces seemed unfortunately a rather timely topic. Cather's description of nostalgia for the "old days" also resonated with us. It seems there's always a human yearning for a "simpler" time, even if the recollection of that past is rose-colored, hazy, or inaccurate. F. Scott Fitzgerald was a great admirer of Cather and this story in particular. Check out The Great Gatsby and see if Daisy Buchanan doesn't remind you more than a little of Mrs. Forrester.

January 2026: The Correspondent: A Novel by Virginia Evans (Fiction)

Universally loved and compelling. The epistolary format revealed the crises, joys, and complexities of Sybil's life, as well as the variety of deep—and not so deep—relationships she experienced through writing. We were touched by the discovery that it was Gilbert with whom she'd been corresponding for all those years. We also appreciated the intricacies of Sybil's character—she was rigid about some things, open and compassionate about others, and bewildered about some of the most basic facts of her life. We shared moments in our own lives when we wished we had been more attentive to our children. Very thought-provoking.

February 2026: The River is Waiting by Wally Lamb (Fiction)

This was a very difficult read. Some of us abandoned it more than once, only to finally pick it up. We were reluctant to immerse ourselves in the painful world of Corby Ledbetter and his family, after the heartbreakingly tragic event that sets the story in motion. We did appreciate Lamb's impressive writing skills, which made us care about Corby in spite of his flawed character. The story's ending was impossible to predict, as Corby made strides toward rehabilitation in the face of daunting challenges. The last section of the book seemed to some of us too easy and pat a resolution. That said, we agreed that because of the emotions that the trauma of this book stirred, it would be challenging to recommend it without reservations or trigger warnings.

LFPR Third Thursday Women's Book Group (continued)

March 2026: My Friends: A Novel by Fredrik Backman (Fiction)

It was too bad that Snowstorm Elsa messed up our plans, because the differing views of Fredrik Backman's My Friends would have made for a lively chat! Overall, the majority reaction of the group was: "Meh." Readers who enjoyed other books by Backman deemed this one "not my favorite." One of us even returned it to the library after 60 pages. Some books are like that! Even those who (mostly) liked it mentioned "bumpy reading" or "heavy going". Those who did enjoy it liked: the ultimately positive message; the different plot threads; the themes of the power of friendship and art; and the art mystery component. Better luck next time, Fredrik!

****We next meet on April 16 and will read All the Broken Places by John Boyne.**



Neighbors in the News

Emily Baker, 3244 LFPR, recently published her first novel, The Last Empress.

Emily is a lifelong lover of writing and all things books. As the daughter of a librarian, she grew up crafting her first attempts at novels on the family desktop PC. Emily taught middle schoolers to find their own love of books before pursuing her career in writing. Today, she lives on the shores of Lake Michigan, crafting novels and spending time with her dogs Gracie and Penny, her cat Piccola, and her horse Kees. You can also find her writing on Substack under *The Writer on the Water* or follow her Podcast, *The Odyssey of a Novel* pod.

The Last Empress creates a world where the gods have gifted only women with the most powerful magic, and the ruling Council will do anything to keep that hidden. But when Ophelia June discovers the truth, she becomes the only person with the power to change everything.

Visit <http://www.emilyelizabethbaker.com/> to learn more. Emily writes on Substack as *The Writer on the Water* at emilyebaker.substack.com



Photo credit:
Sue Behrens

What I Wish I'd Known Before I Moved to a Small Town

by Emily Baker (3244 LFPR)

There is something different about a small town, the kind of place where your entire county could fit inside an NFL stadium twice and still have room to spare. Of course, there are the stereotypes. You can't go to the store or your favorite restaurant without seeing someone you know. You know all of the staff at the local bar, the post office, and the market.

But there are the quieter things, too. The ones no one really talks about when they glamorize living in a big city where you are a dot on a map, a whisper in the cacophony.

When you live in a small town, it's not just that everyone knows you; it is that everyone is invested in you as their community member. Genuinely, and in expectation of nothing in return, they are there to help you, champion you, or support you. And that is something magical that I think deserves to be talked about more.

In a Past Life

There was a time when I craved the potential and the chaos of a crowded bar. The adrenaline and eardrum-rattling noise of a sporting event or concert.

There was a time when I was weighing moving to even bigger cities: San Francisco, New York, London.

There was a time when the slowness of a small town would have terrified me. Not in a horror movie way, but rather a fear of that high viscosity. If I am not at the party, at the event, in the group chat, would I be forgotten? Would I be alone?

The Kindness of Neighbors

When I moved to Door County, I did it alone. When I say that, I mean without the company of another person. I am, of course, still in the company of my border collies, my cat, and my horse.

At this point in time, this didn't frighten or bother me. The version of me that I am now is, by nature, a solitary person. Most days, I would choose my own company (and that of my animals) over the company of others because I simply enjoy being by myself. It's when things went wrong, when I needed the help of others, that I noticed my isolation for the first time. Until I realized I wasn't, in fact, isolated.

Through the course of this winter, I have had two different trees fall in the night and block my driveway. I have a "chainsaw" the size of a paintbrush and some branch trimming tools, none of which were equipped to carve up these monsters that had trapped me in. Without even a thought, my neighbors down the road popped by, sliced them up, and rolled them off the driveway for me. I didn't even ask. They were not the only ones to offer, either!



**My little, albeit
isolated, slice of
paradise.**

What I Wish I'd Known Before I Moved to a Small Town (continued)

Twice I have come home from work, on a day when the trash had not been picked up before I left, to find that an unknown someone had rolled my trash cans all the way back up my long driveway for me. "The neighborhood fairy," my neighbor called them. Someone who sought no recognition but provided help.

Only a few days ago, I ran over a bolt in town and my tire quite literally turned into a pancake. It would be an easy fix, but it was a Sunday evening in a small town, and there was almost nothing open, especially not a tire shop. I knew I had to leave it in town, but the question was how I would get home and then back in to work the next day? Within two minutes, one of my new friends here had shown up to pick me up and give me a ride home. Promptly at 9:40 the next morning, another of my new friends arrived to give me a ride to work and get me there on time. And then another of my friends drove me to pick up my car at the end of the day.

And yet another of them checked in unprompted to make sure my dilemma was resolved the next day. When I had another issue with my car, it had to get towed to the nearest dealership for repairs, an hour and a half away. Without even a thought, the owner of the bookshop I work at lent me one of her cars. She had never been in a vehicle with me; I could have been a maniac behind the wheel for all she knew. And still she gave.



Emily and friends at her book signing



Emily and her fellow staff at Novel Bay Booksellers, along with owner Liz Welter

More than once, if not regularly, people I have recently met and am only just getting to know have reached out to me to send me something "that made them think of me" or dropped by the bookstore to gift me a favorite book of theirs that "they thought I might like." And you know what- they were right! These are articles, books, and thoughts that resonate perfectly for me. Some of them will even be reading this post (I see you! Thank you!) These are only a fraction of the examples of the simple kindnesses from a community of people who ask nothing in return. I am not from here. I'm probably one of the newest residents on the peninsula, and yet immediately everyone here accepted me as one of their own to care for, protect, and uplift.

Without this small town, I'm not sure if or when I would have published my book to the success that I did, but this place and these people gave me that stage without me even asking.

The beauty of welcoming a stranger into your midst and offering them kindness is something I think we could all use a little more of. And maybe, just maybe, we could all learn a little something by living in a small town.

Broadband

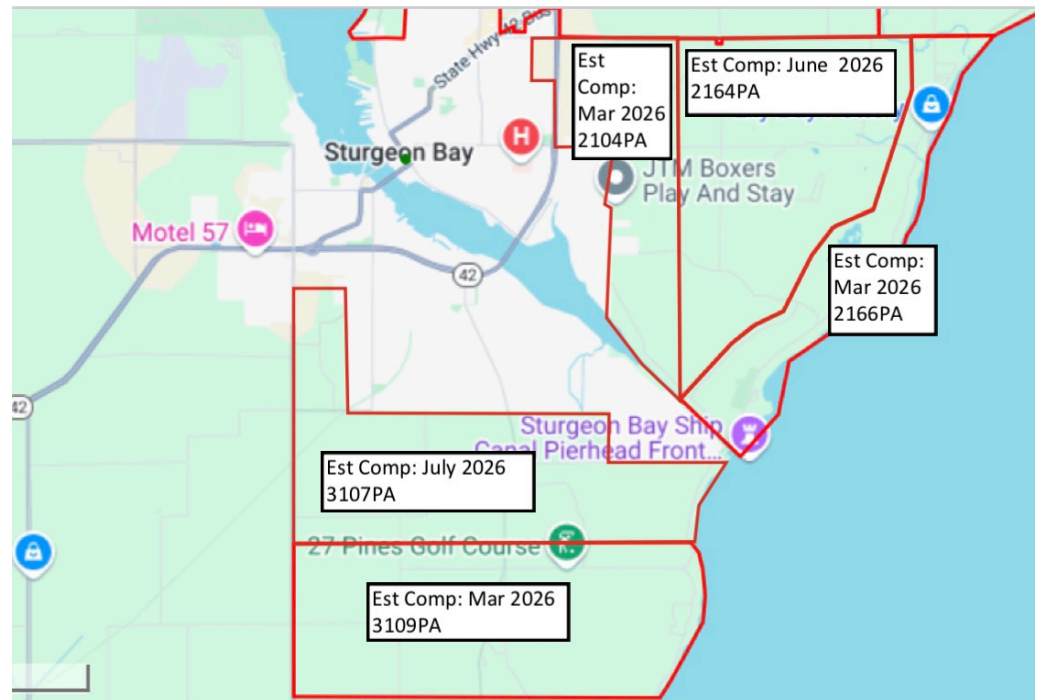
The following is from AT&T information sent to the Town of Sturgeon Bay, edited for length. - Ed.

AT&T Fiber Build Status

Our teams have been making significant strides both on-site and behind the scenes to advance the fiber installation project.

We want to express our appreciation to the Town for having such a positive process for permitting and awareness.

Please refer to the map for the latest updates, which outline the general project areas within your community.



Kindly note that details may evolve as the project progresses due to various factors.

The map also includes our **estimated project completion timelines** for all areas within the Town, offering a clear overview of the project's phased approach. These timelines may be subject to change, and we are committed to providing monthly updates as progress continues.

Our teams estimate that 3 of the 5 project areas may be complete and ready for ordering services by the end of March, 2026, and the entire Town may be completed by the end of July (ahead of schedule).

Residents will see some additional activity from our local sales teams in the area, sharing information and potentially taking pre-orders for service in these areas that will be AT&T fiber ready first.

AT&T wishes to be very clear that these are only estimates and dates may change due to a variety of factors.

Propane Update

by Rod Miller (5087 CTH TT) and Mike Johnston (2672 LFPR)

Dan Biebel from the Bay Shore Drive Homeowners Association, will once again be leading the propane negotiations for the 2026-2027 heating season. The intent is to focus on Ferrellgas because the association members have been very satisfied with both the customer service and the delivery service from Ferrellgas this past year. Proposals will also be solicited from Lakes Gas and probably AmeriGas.

Just a reminder that the current Ferrellgas agreement at \$1.549 per gallon continues until July 31, 2026 and the current Lakes Gas agreement at \$1.699 per gallon continues until June 30, 2026. As negotiations progress later this spring into early summer, we will share the updates and the details so you can make an informed decision regarding your preferred propane vendor for the 2026-2027 heating season.

Given the current geopolitical situation, we will quite likely see higher propane pricing in the new contract. Please keep in mind that participation in the special negotiated price for the purchase of LP Gas is one of the benefits of Lake Forest Park Road Association membership, but it is completely voluntary.

Town of Sturgeon Bay News

by Jeff Feuerstein (2500 Canal Road)

Information on the Town, various contracts, ordinances, etc., is available on the Town website, townofsturgeonbay-wi.gov. You can be notified of new postings to the website via text or email; information is available on the webpage. All are welcome to attend any Town meetings; they are open to the public. Check out the agendas and come support issues important to you. If you have interest in serving on the Town Board, please let me know.

As mentioned elsewhere in the newsletter, most of us will have access to broadband within a month or so. Thanks to the Town of Sturgeon Bay Broadband Committee, who have been working on this for nearly 3 years: David Wood, Randy Graf, Pam Kraase, and Cathy Eckers.

The Town requires that contractors working in the right of ways along the road submit permits, so that any damages or issues can be corrected by the contractors, and so the Town can be reimbursed. With the installation of the fiber optic, AT&T and its contractors and subcontractors will be restoring some construction damage. Most of this work occurs in Spring,

They have asked residents to contact them **directly** to report if work is needed.

Contact: Daryl Kate, Holtger Brothers, (920) 617-9927

History Resurfaces at Portage Part (Part 2)

by John Vincent (2794 LFPR)

In last Fall's newsletter, we explored the remains of a large wooden structure that appeared in shallow water at Portage Park just north of Rocky Point. The structure nestled in sand and rock (**See Exhibit 1**) is about 50 feet long and 8 feet wide with long wood planks secured by what appears to be regularly spaced crossbeams. In the Fall article we speculated about what the structure might be, with thoughts ranging from a shipwreck, to a logging pier, to a fishing dock, and to a seawall. Well, the experts from the Wisconsin Historical Society have weighed in and this is what we now know.



**Exhibit 1 -
Aerial view
of the
remnant**

Not a Logging Pier

"It is 100% not a pier fragment," according to Tamara Thomsen, Maritime Archeologist of the State Historic Preservation Office. Her reasoning is that the timbers are not "robust enough" to support the load requirements of a logging pier and lack the "longitudinal members" that would be part of pier construction. During the 1870s, a logging pier, first known as "Tufts' Pier", then later as "Scott's Pier," operated on Portage Bay at what is now the Winnebago public access, about a mile northeast of where our wooden remnant was found. This 1872 pier was 20 feet wide and about 400 feet long, and built strong enough to support mule-drawn wagons, laden with logs and driven out over the lake to waiting sailing ships.¹ The pier was abandoned after only five years of operation and then left to nature; it disappeared by the early 1900s.² If not Scott's Pier, what is this wooden remnant lying on the lake bottom at Portage Park?

Local History (continued)

Not a Traditional Vessel

“The piece is a 54 foot long hull fragment of a barge” Tamara observed, with its interior framework facing up and its outer hull facing down. She said the cross timbers (**see Exhibit 2**) “are king posts for strengthening the side of a barge hull.” The twisted pieces of hardware protruding from the king post (**see Exhibit 3**) are “iron fasteners”. The flatness of the fragment is consistent with barge construction. According to Tamara, a “traditionally built vessel,” like a sailing or self-propelled ship, “would have had curvature to its hull”. Interpreting the hull’s tapered edge indicated in the **Exhibit 4** photo, Tamara concluded “this image represents the bow entry of the side of the hull of a barge.”



**Exhibit 2 (LEFT) -
A king post**



**Exhibit 3 (RIGHT) -
Iron fasteners**



**Exhibit 4 –
Tapered edge
of hull at bow
entry**

Local History (continued)

The Pankratz Barge No. 2

Curious as to the source of the wreck, Tamara and her Historical Society colleague, Kendra Kennedy, scoured newspapers and marine records for any reports of barge losses in the immediate vicinity. The most likely candidate is the wreck of the Pankratz barge No. 2, which occurred in November 1900.

Earlier that year, the George Pankratz Lumber Company of Sturgeon Bay commissioned the construction of three large scows, including barge No. 2, for transporting timber and stone.³

Exhibit 5 shows an example of a loaded scow being towed by a tugboat. On Tuesday evening, November 20, 1900, “barge #2 laden with 150 cords of stone” was in tow by the tug *Duncan City* and bound for Whitehall, Michigan. Nearing the lake end of the canal by the lighthouse, as she passed an incoming tug on her starboard side, both “tug and scow sheered rapidly to port.”

Exhibit 5: A scow example



Now under full steam to right her course and burden, the tug’s port tow line snapped and the barge ran headlong into a piling on the side of the canal, punching a hole in the starboard bow. “While she was going down, the current, which was running out, swung the stern of the sinking craft squarely across the channel, and her ends rest on either bank. As she went down the air pressure blew her hatches off with loud reports. The stone (still onboard) was only about four feet under water and her cabin was above the surface.”⁴

This was the first time in the canal’s brief history that the passage was blocked to all navigation.⁵ Work commenced that Thursday morning to remove the obstruction. Local marine diver Thomas Isabell went down and examined the craft and found, but for the breach in its bow, that the craft was intact and likely seaworthy. It was thought that once relieved of its heavy load, the barge would float to the surface and could be towed away for repair. After all the stone was removed by Saturday afternoon, the scow did not float as expected but remained moored in the mud at the bottom of the canal. “On Sunday Diver Isabell was called on to make another examination” and it was determined that the only way to dislodge her was “to blow her up with dynamite.”⁶

Local History (continued)

On Monday, “dynamite was put in the hold and exploded by means of an electric wire. Great pieces of her decks and sides were thus torn out, sometimes a good-sized hunk being blown in the air higher than the lighthouse tower.” Tugs then pulled the debris out into the lake where it was dumped.⁷ **Exhibit 6** shows the location of where the barge sank in the canal, where the demolished remains were released in the lake, and where the side of the barge (our remnant) recently resurfaced near the shore.

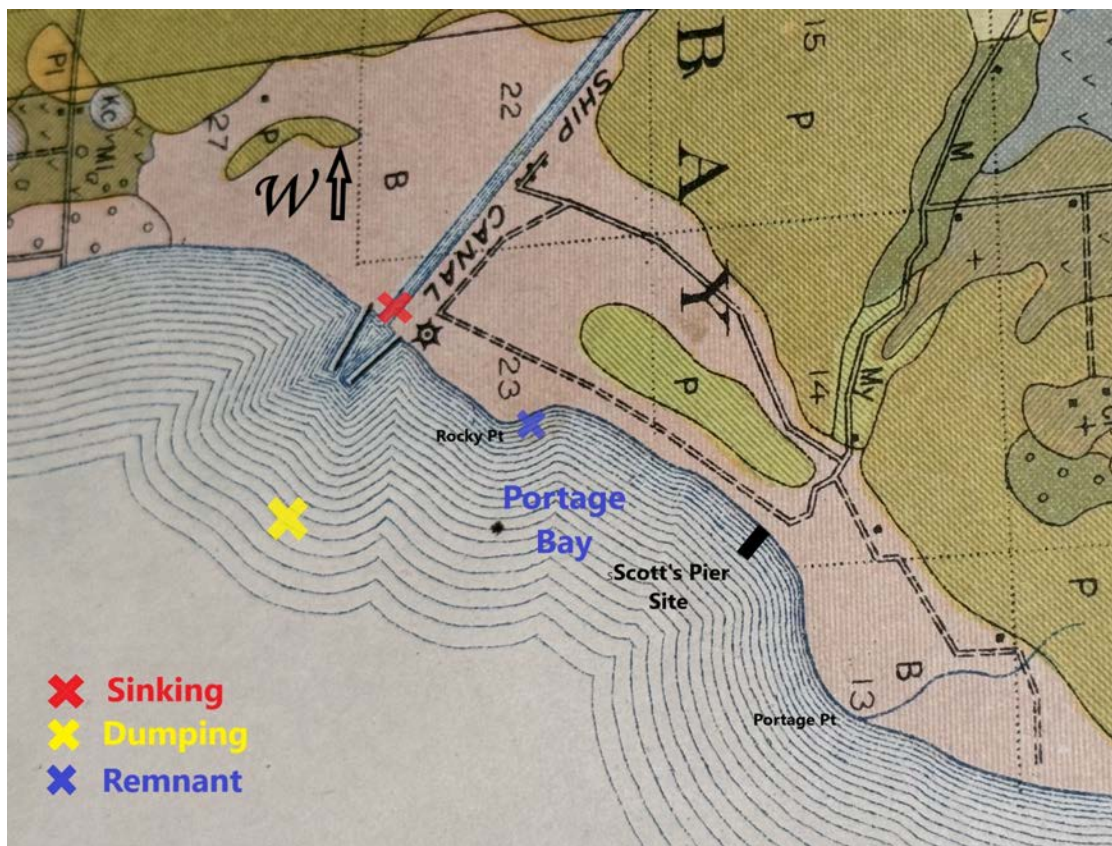


Exhibit 6 – Excerpt
from 1919 Door
County soil map

It's been 125 years since that eventful week at the entrance to the canal. Thanks to the State Historical Society's research, we now have a story to attach to the wooden remnant visible in the shallow water near Rocky Point. Over time, will the lake recede and expose the preserved wreckage to the elements, hastening its degradation? Will a resurgence of high water once again bury it in sand, only to be rediscovered by another generation? Or will it remain as it is, an offshore fixture and sturdy reminder of an earlier time.

Local History (continued)

Acknowledgements

My thanks to Tamara Thomsen, Kendra Kennedy & Bob LaViolette (Wisconsin Historical Society), Bob Jaeck (WUAA), Doug Weimer (Clay Banks Historian), and Matt Adelman (Door County Museum Archivist) for their contributions to this article.

Footnotes

¹ *Door County Advocate*, 6/20/1872, p. 3, col. 2; and *Ghost Port Settlements and Shipwrecks in Door County's Clay Banks Township: A Wisconsin Maritime Study* by Dr. Richard Boyd, Russel Leitz and Douglas Weimer; 2020; A Wisconsin Underwater Archeological Association (WUAA) research publication, p. 51.

² *The Advocate*, 4/18/1907, p. 8, col. 3.

³ *The Advocate*, 12/1/1900, p. 1, col. 1; and *The Marine Record*, March 15, 1900, p. 7.

⁴ *The Advocate*, 11/24/1900, p. 1, col. 1.

⁵ *Door County Democrat*, 11/24/1900, p. 8, col. 5.

⁶ *The Advocate*, 12/1/1900, p. 1, col. 1.

⁷ *Ibid.*



After the Winter by Claude McKay

Source: Claude McKay: Complete Poems
(University of Illinois Press, 2004)

Some day, when trees have shed their leaves
And against the morning's white
The shivering birds beneath the eaves
Have sheltered for the night,
We'll turn our faces southward, love,
Toward the summer isle
Where bamboos spire the shafted grove
And wide-mouthed orchids smile.

And we will seek the quiet hill
Where towers the cotton tree,
And leaps the laughing crystal rill,
And works the droning bee.
And we will build a cottage there
Beside an open glade,
With black-ribbed blue-bells blowing near,
And ferns that never fade.

Land Trust Acquires Garrity Property on LFPR

by Lucia Hodkiewicz, Door County Land Trust

The Door County Land Trust recently purchased 149 acres along Lake Forest Park Road from Dennis and Sue Garrity, protecting an exceptional example of ridge and swale landscape within the Kellner Fen Natural Area.

The ecologically significant property will be stewarded to protect water quality, rare species, migratory bird habitat, and forest health for generations to come. The property is in an area of Door County with significant conservation value. Its proximity to Lake Michigan and the Kellner Fen wetland earns it a designation as a Priority Stopover Site for migratory birds by WDNR.

The fragile embayment wetland is home to abundant and diverse populations of sedges, bullrushes, rare orchids, and critical breeding habitat for an endangered dragonfly. The parcel hosts a series of ridges and swales shaped by lake action over thousands of years—a type of landscape that is ranked as imperiled in the state of Wisconsin and vulnerable globally.



Photo credit: Emily Wood

Land Trust Acquires Garrity Property on LFPR (continued)

Due to its ecological significance and its proximity to existing protected lands, Door County Land Trust has been interested in the Garrity property for over a decade. Protection of this property allows for its long-term stewardship, ensuring that hydrologic processes and water quality are monitored, the forest canopy and migratory corridors remain intact, and development is prevented.

The Land Trust plans to take inventory of any invasive species present on the property and implement a control plan. To mitigate over-browsing and help control the deer population, the property will be open for all bow and gun seasons.

The Garritys sold their property to the Land Trust in a bargain sale below appraised market value and the tract will be known as The Dennis and Susan Garrity Family Tract at Kellner Fen Natural Area.

Land protection is not accidental—it is only possible when willing landowners consider conservation. The Land Trust thanks Sue and Dennis Garrity for being willing to work together to save a remarkable part of Door County. Protecting land like the Garrity's is made possible through member donations—*thank you!*

In addition to donations from supporters and Land Trust members, the purchase of this property is made possible in part by grant funding from the Natural Resources Damage Assessment and Restoration (NRDAR) program through the Fox River Trustee Council and through the WI-DNR Knowles-Nelson Stewardship Fund (KNSF). This purchase is the Land Trust's last project being funded by the KNSF under its current funding cycle, which will end in July without a plan for renewal. If you care to see land protection continue at a pace that attempts to keep up with rapid development, now is a critical time for your voice to be heard. Tell our legislators to work together to renew this bipartisan program which has been critical to many land protection projects throughout Door County.

About the Door County Land Trust

Protecting Door County's Exceptional Lands and Waters...*Forever*. Door County Land Trust protects the wild places, scenic beauty, and ecological integrity that make the peninsula and islands so special. 15 featured nature preserves are open for hiking, and other low-impact, non-motorized recreational activities--all at no charge to the public. Trail maps and more information may be found at www.doorcountylandtrust.org.